YUPENG LIU

Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado Boulder
995 Regent Drive, Boulder, CO 80309
Yupeng.Liu@colorado.edu | yupeng-liu.com | LinkedIn | Google Scholar

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Yupeng Liu is a PhD student in Strategy and Entrepreneurship at the Leeds School of Business. His research sits at the intersection of innovation, entrepreneurship, and the policies that shape them. He is curious about how knowledge moves across the boundaries of firms, communities, and countries, and about what turns a new idea into a high-growth venture. Alongside his research, he also builds tools for researchers and the wider academic community.

Before the PhD, he was a research associate on the Startup Cartography Project at Columbia Business School, then spent three years in Singapore at a global consulting firm.

EDUCATION

University of Colorado Boulder, Leeds School of Business — Boulder, CO
Ph.D. in Strategy and Entrepreneurship (expected 2030) — 08/2025 – Present

Georgetown University — Washington, DC
M.A. in Applied Economics — 08/2017 – 08/2018

University of Birmingham — Birmingham, United Kingdom
B.Sc. in Mathematics with Honors — 09/2014 – 06/2017
First Class Degree; ranked 2nd in a cohort of 200+

Huazhong University of Science and Technology — Wuhan, China
B.A. in Management (International Business) — 09/2012 – 06/2017
GPA: 3.8/4.0

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Andrews, Raymond J., Catherine Fazio, Jorge Guzman, **Yupeng Liu**, and Scott Stern (2022)[1]. "The Startup Cartography Project: Measuring and mapping entrepreneurial ecosystems." *Research Policy*, 51(2), 104437.

WORKING PAPERS

Liu, Yupeng, Tony W. Tong, and Yuping Li. "Dependence Reconfiguration: Open-Source Governance as a Response to Geopolitical Restrictions on Critical Technologies."

Tong, Tony W., **Yupeng Liu**, and Shihao Zhou. "The Rise of National AI Ecosystems: Geopolitical Competition and the State as Ecosystem Orchestrator."

Fazio, Catherine, Jorge Guzman, **Yupeng Liu**, and Scott Stern (2021). "How is COVID Changing the Geography of Entrepreneurship? Evidence from the Startup Cartography Project." NBER Working Paper #28787.

Guzman, Jorge, and **Yupeng Liu** (2019). "Do Entrepreneurs Respond to Everyday Changes in Financing Costs?"

RESEARCH IN PROGRESS

"Construct Laplace." construct-laplace.org

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

Strategic Management Society Annual Conference, Berlin, Germany — October 2026
Research Seminar, ETH Zurich, Zurich, Switzerland — October 2026
Academy of Management Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA — August 2026
Open and User Innovation Conference, Harvard Business School, Boston, MA — July 2026
Strategy Science Conference, Leeds School of Business, University of Colorado Boulder — May 2026
Eastern Economic Association Annual Conference, Boston, MA — February 2020

[1] All authors contributed equally; author names are listed alphabetically.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Ad hoc reviewer: *Management and Organization Review*.

Strategy Science Conference 2026: built the conference website (strategyscience2026.org) on GitHub and Cloudflare Pages.

ACKNOWLEDGED RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Bryan, Kevin, and Jorge Guzman (2023). "Entrepreneurial Migration." *Review of Economics and Statistics*.

Guzman, Jorge (2023). "The Direct Effect of Corporate Law on Entrepreneurship." *The Journal of Law, Economics, and Organization*, ewad024.

Fazio, Catherine, Jorge Guzman, and Scott Stern (2020). "The Impact of State-Level R&D Tax Credits on the Quantity and Quality of Entrepreneurship." *Economic Development Quarterly*, 34(2), 188–208.

Guzman, Jorge, and Scott Stern (2020). "The State of American Entrepreneurship: New Estimates of the Quantity and Quality of Entrepreneurship for 32 US States, 1988–2014." *American Economic Journal: Economic Policy*, 12(4), 212–243.

Catalini, Christian, Jorge Guzman, and Scott Stern (2019). "Passive Versus Active Growth: Evidence from Founder Choices and Venture Capital Investment." NBER Working Paper #26073.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ernst & Young (EY) Singapore

Senior Associate, Digital Forensic Specialist 02/2023 – 06/2025

- Developed and deployed rule-based and predictive models in Python and SQL to identify suspicious transactions, focusing on procurement fraud and travel-and-entertainment expenses across transportation, retail, and energy.
- Automated DeFi transaction monitoring in Python, tracking balances and suspicious flows across Ethereum, Bitcoin, and Terra to uncover fraud at a crypto-lending firm tied to the 2022 Terra Luna collapse.
- Applied NLP to chat histories and OCR to graphical documents, converting unstructured records into structured evidence for investigations.
- Tested a major port authority's sanctions screening system using manipulated OFAC party lists to evaluate its fuzzy matching algorithm.
- Presented findings in Power BI and Tableau dashboards, translating investigation reports into evidence supporting or refuting custodial claims.

Columbia Business School New York, NY

Full-Time Research Associate, The Startup Cartography Project 10/2018 – 06/2020

- Acquired, parsed, and cleaned 44 million business registration records from 50 U.S. Secretary of State offices, merging them with USPTO patent and trademark histories and SDC Platinum M&A data to estimate firm growth indicators.
- Built logit and random-forest models to estimate entrepreneurial quality indices; published and maintained state-, county-, and ZIP-level datasets for public use, and geocoded firm addresses for interactive maps.
- Worked with the Kentucky Secretary of State's office on regional entrepreneurship analysis and visualization for state officials.
- Developed quality-adjusted distance measures for research on firm agglomeration.

SKILLS

Methods: Difference-in-differences and staggered DID (Callaway–Sant'Anna), panel causal inference, quasi-experimental design, machine learning for prediction, text analysis and neural embeddings.

Data: Large-scale GitHub and Hugging Face panels, web-scale collection and parsing, business registration and administrative records, USPTO patents and trademarks, Common Crawl, job postings.

Software: Python, Stata, R, SQL, Git, Power BI, Tableau.

Languages: Chinese (native), English (fluent), French (beginner).